How the Claude Code team does code review

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AI writes 90% of Claude Code. Who reviews it?

90%
of Claude Code is written by Claude

2×+
merged pull requests, June to September

−40%+
share of pull requests that had to be reverted

01 Line-by-line human review becomes the bottleneck.

02 AI handles the routine checks.

03 People keep the high-risk decisions.

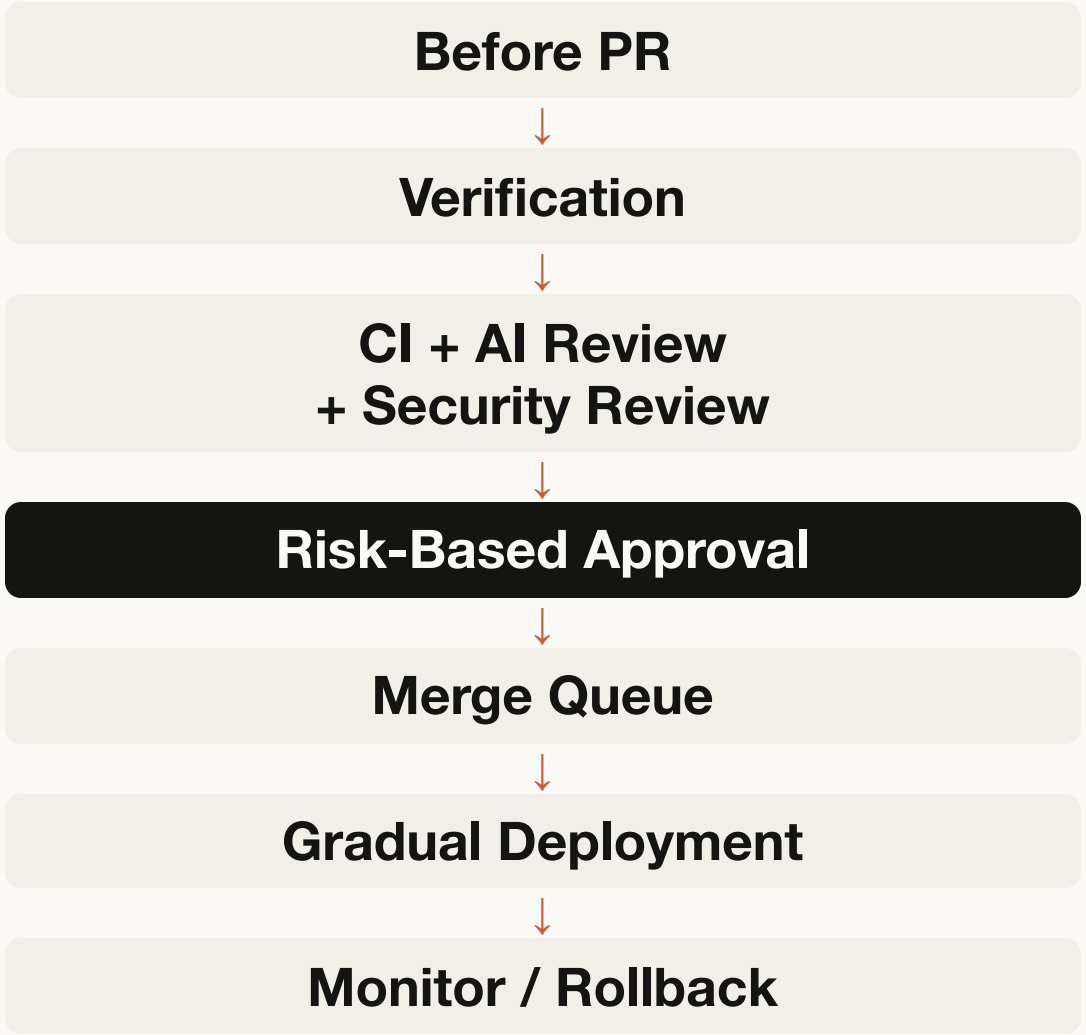
OPTIMIZATION OBJECTIVE

Minimize human review time

Subject to no increase in revert rates or incident rates.

Same months. These describe the whole engineering process. They are not credited to AI review alone.

The Life of a Change



Before the PR

The work is verified first.

On the pull request

CI, AI review, and security run on their own.

A person steps in

Only where the risk tier requires it.

After it merges

Flag, gradual release, then watch or roll back.

Verification Before the PR

STEP 1

Run Real Checks

Tests, a build, or a screenshot compared with the design. Claude shows the output.

STEP 2

Independent Review

A fresh-context subagent reviews the code changes.

STEP 3

Project-Specific Rules

The reviewer loads rules written for this project.

CLAUDE.md

Every task loads it. A broken rule is flagged, and so is a line this change made stale.

REVIEW.md

Review only. Hunters and checkers both read it, from the default branch, not the pull request.

How AI Reviews AI

Current Code Review. Each agent hunts a different kind of bug. Then a check drops false alarms.

1 · LOOK

Different jobs

Agents run in parallel.

Each one hunts one kind of issue: logic, security, or a regression.

2 · CHECK

Test the claim

A later step checks each candidate against the real code.

If it is not real, it is dropped.

3 · POST

Rank what remains

Important, Nit, or Pre-existing.

Style and guesses stay out.

A finding is posted only after that check.

The review can flag a bug. It does not approve the pull request.

Human Review Scales With Risk

LOW

0

human approvals

Docs, copy, internal-only, additive changes behind a flag.

MEDIUM

1

human approval

Ordinary product changes.

HIGH

2

human approvals

Highest-risk code, and a few paths that always need two people.

AI findings inform the process, but an AI approval never fills a slot that requires a person.

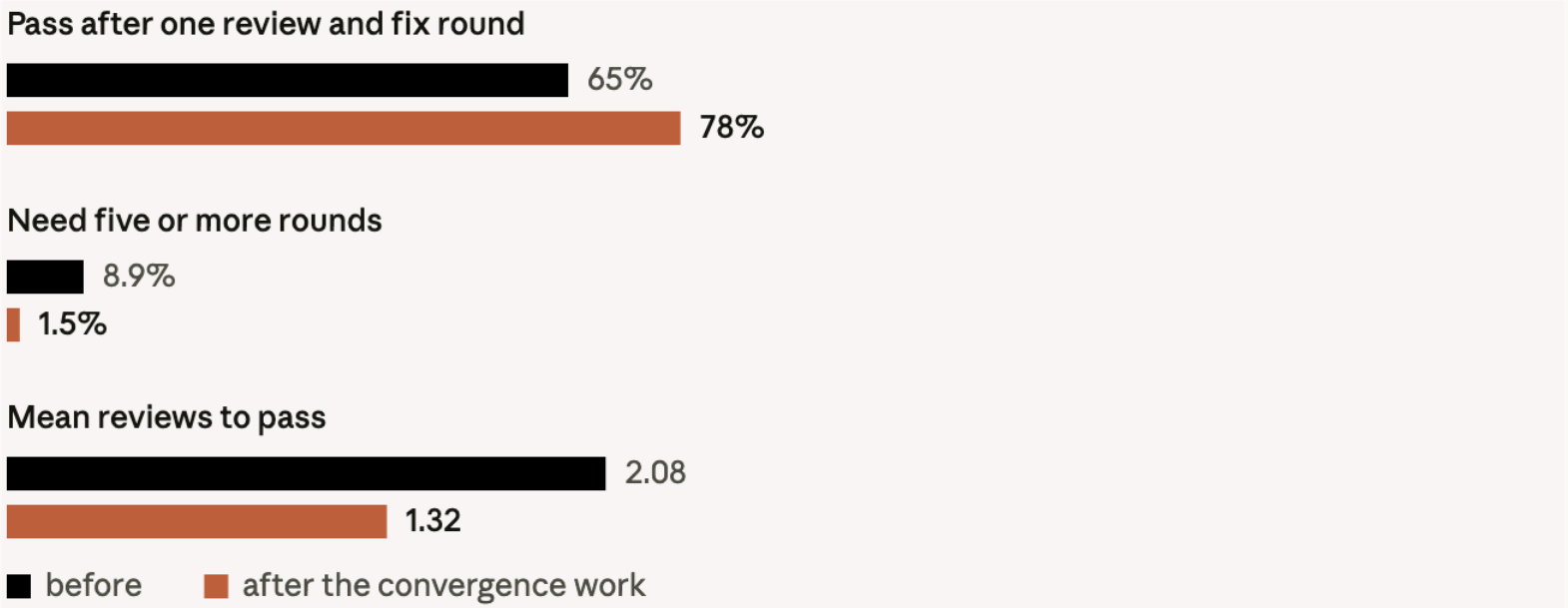
Zero-human approval applies only to eligible trusted authors after required automated checks pass.

When AI Review Gets Stuck

Agent-to-agent review loops can fail to converge without explicit stopping rules.

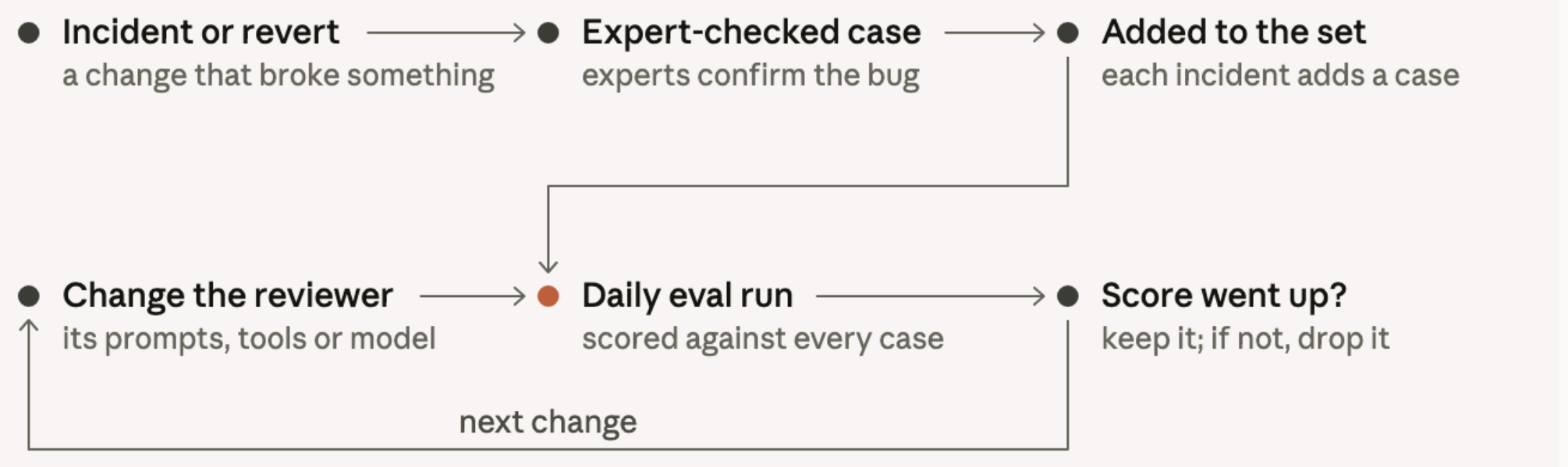
50+

rounds on one pull request, overnight



Review-loop counts, after stopping rules. Separate from the June–September revert rate.

Evaluation and Human Accountability



People still decide: whether to build it, risky code, architecture, the evidence, and who owns the outcome.

AI can write and review code,
but humans remain accountable for what ships.

AI Disclosure: Cursor was used to assist with slide design and formatting. Content was reviewed against the original article.